

GM Quick Hints — per puzzle

Pull out when a group phones in stuck. Give hints in order (H1 → H2 → H3 → Emergency). Skip levels only when time is critical. Z2/Z3: hints delivered over the phone.

Z1 — Symbol Trail expected ~20–30 min · report = 4 places in order

ANSWER: **group-specific – see their group card or master board**

H1 GENTLE *"Match the image on your cipher card to what you physically see — it's something actually there, not something you'd need to know. Look closely."*

H2 MEDIUM *"You're looking for [describe the type of object — e.g. an animal / a number / a building feature]. That image is on your cipher card."*

H3 DIRECT Name the next location directly. Time matters more than the puzzle at this stage.

ON WRONG LOOP *"You've walked 4+ places — does the last one say KONIEC (END)? If not, you're on the wrong path. Go back to the very first symbol on your K1 envelope and start again."*

Z2 — Morning Errands logic puzzle in K2 · no MG checkpoint — hints by phone if they call

ANSWER: **Jordan → Piccolo (hot-food place) – bought a ladle** (Lambert → Old Mill / bread · Kordian → Smithy / cloth)

H1 GENTLE *"Clue 2 tells you something about Jordan directly. Start there."*

H2 MEDIUM *"Lambert bought food outside his own place — so he can't work at the food place. That rules one out for him. Work from there."*

H3 DIRECT *"Jordan works at Piccolo. Go there and ask for him by name."*

Z3 — Castle / Theft Zosia/Albrecht runs this · theft is mandatory · every group must succeed

GOAL: **steal parchment (pergamin) while Albrecht's back is turned · bring to MG**

H1 ON-SITE **Signal Zosia** (don't call the group). Ask her to slow her patrol / lengthen Phase A (away time).

H2 PHONE GROUP *"Read the envelope you received from the commander. The instructions are there."*

H3 DIRECT *"You need the parchment he was reading from. He sets it down and walks away — wait until his back is turned, then take it cleanly."*

EMERGENCY Zosia unavailable: hand group the pergamin directly. *"A contact managed to get this from inside."* Z4 continues normally.

Z4 — Kalimba listen to melody → play back → write 6 note-numbers → report

CODE: **6 · 2 · 1 · 4 · 5 · 4** – exact order, 6 digits. Do NOT confirm partial codes.

H1 GENTLE *"Play it slower than you think. One note at a time — write the number before you move to the next."*

H2 REPLAY *"Replay the melody more slowly. 'Count as you go — don't try to remember it all at the end.'"*

H3 COUNT *"You have exactly six notes. You're close — make sure you haven't missed one." (Do NOT give any digit.)*

EMERGENCY (<30 min to 20:30) *"A contact passed on the boatman's code: 6, 2, 1, 4, 5, 4." Hand K8 directly.*

Z7 — Cezar Cipher shift +7 · compare motto headers on szyfrogram (K8) vs pergamin (Z3 list)

ANSWER: **HANS VON BAYSEN IS JORDAN THE COOK** – accept core: "Hans von Baysen". Full phrase can be paraphrased.

H1 GENTLE *"Look at the very top of that letter. You've seen that script before today — somewhere you've already been."*

H2 MEDIUM *"Compare the heading of the cipher letter with the heading of the names list you stole. Same font, same punctuation. Count how many steps each letter moved — same shift every time."*

H3 KEY ONLY (<30 min) *"The shift is 7 — every letter moved 7 steps forward. Apply that backwards."*

EMERGENCY *"It reads: HANS VON BAYSEN IS JORDAN THE COOK. Who does that make Jordan?"*

TWIST DID NOT UNLOCK *"Group 12 decoded but seems unmoved — ask: 'Who were you sent to deliver that letter to, from the very start?' → then: 'Look at the top of the names list — what does it say beside the first name?' Let them connect it themselves."*